

HP PHOTOSMART D7368

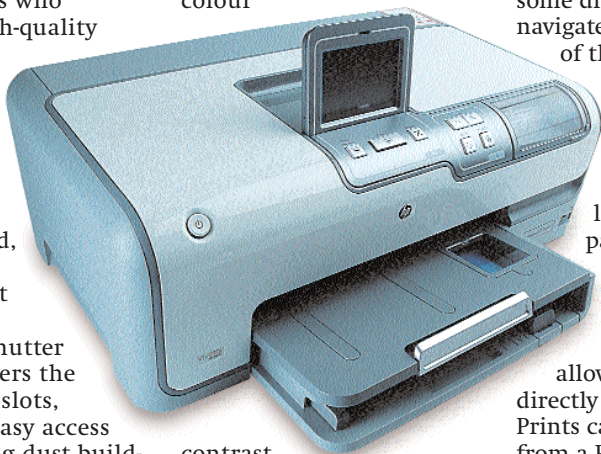
A photographer's companion

The HP Photosmart series is targeted at photographers who demand a high-quality photo printer.

The Photosmart D7368 looks tidy; the design is elegant. Build quality is good, with sturdy, neatly-laid out trays. A transparent shutter gracefully covers the memory card slots, allowing for easy access and preventing dust build-up.

The printer took about 6 minutes to print an A4 size photo at best quality. The colour prints were some of the best we've seen with an inkjet printer! Finer aspects were reproduced in detail, and throughout the test

procedure, the prints had a neutral tone. In addition, colour



contrast ratio is notably good, allowing for more vivid colour reproduction. Textures were reproduced in detail, and even metallic shine was rendered with the proper lustre on photo paper. In draft mode, black was reproduced as a dark

shade of grey, but this was rectified when we switched to normal print quality.

The low-resolution touch-screen is easy use, but still requires the use of some discrete keys to navigate certain menus. All of the printer's

functionality can be easily accessed via the touch-screen. Basic help for procedures such as loading cartridges, paper loading, and paper jam is provided as animations. The memory card slot allows taking prints directly from memory card. Prints can even be taken from a PictBridge-compatible digicam via USB.

The software bundle

makes printing as well as basic editing a simple process even for novices.

Notable is Photosmart Premier: it is a slightly advanced image-enhancement application, and allows for taking customised prints in varying sizes.

Photographers and even photo enthusiasts who click a lot, and require a neutral toned, high-quality printer, should certainly consider this printer a good buy to suit their needs.

Specifications

4800 x 1200 dpi; 3.4-inch touch-screen; internal memory 64 MB; dimensions (W x D x H): 462.5 x 387.3 x 172.9 mm, weight: 8 kg; tray capacity: 100 sheets

RATINGS

Performance	★★★★★
Features	★★★★★
Ease of Use	★★★★★
Value for Money	★★★★★
Overall	★★★★★

Contact: Hewlett-Packard India Pvt. LTD

Phone: 1800 42 54 999

E-mail: vibhor.bansal@hp.com

Website: www.hp.com

Price: Rs 10,999

XFX 8600GTS and 8600GT

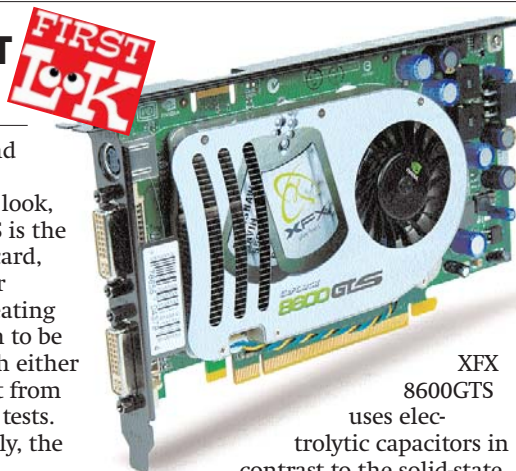
Mrs Green just got twins!

NVIDIA's G84 comes to life as we present 2 cores based on it a.k.a the 8600GTS and the 8600GT.

One can immediately tell these are minnows compared to the colossal 8800GTX. Both cards are based around a 32-shader unit core, fed by 256 MB of GDDR3 memory. The difference is only in clock speeds,

both core and memory.

From its look, the 8600GTS is the higher-end card, with a larger heatsink. Heating doesn't seem to be an issue with either card, at least from preliminary tests. Unfortunately, the



XFX 8600GTS uses electrolytic capacitors in contrast to the solid-state ones on the 8600GT. Why such a backward step? Did XFX expect users to buy the 8600GT and overclock beyond GTS speeds?

As features go, these cards are identical, expect

the GT version doesn't support HDCP. Pitched as mid-range cards, these are expected to replace the 7600GT and GS Direct X 10 support. Driver support is spot-on with current-gen games, we played 10 games - no issues.

Priced as they are (below) the 8600GTS is costly for a mid-range solution, and considering that clocks aside they're identical. The 8600GT really hits the sweet spot in this regard.

Specifications

8600GTS/GT - 32 shader units; core speed 675/540 MHz; memory speed 2000/1400 MHz; shader unit clock - 1450/1180; 289 million transistors; 256 MB GDDR3 memory (128-bit)

RATINGS

Performance	★★★★★
Features	★★★★★
Bundle	★★★★★
Value for Money	★★★★★
Overall	★★★★★

Contact: Rashi Peripherals

Phone: 022-67090909

Web site: navinderc@rptechindia.com

Price: Rs 16,000 (8600GTS)

Rs 10,000 (8600GT)

